

Integrated Project Delivery — What It Is, Who Uses It in Alberta, and What It Means in BC

KOR Structural · Prepared 2026-07-03 · Every claim carries a source; anything unverified is labeled

How to read this: claims are [V] (verified against a primary source — see the source list), [I] (inferred — the basis is stated), or **UNVERIFIED** (found only in secondary sources; treat as a lead). Section 9 lists what we could not verify. Several widely-repeated “IPD” examples turned out, on checking, to be other delivery models — the text says so where it matters.

1. Executive summary

1. **IPD is a contract, not a philosophy.** In Canada it means CCDC 30 (published 2018, revised 2025): one multi-party agreement signed together by the owner, architect, key engineers, the contractor, and major trades. Costs are reimbursed open-book; **each firm’s entire profit goes into a shared pool** that grows or shrinks with the whole team’s performance against a jointly-set target cost; parties waive claims against each other except for wilful default. [V]
2. **It is a different seat from the one KOR sits in today.** In our normal Prime Consultant work, KOR is the architect’s sub-consultant: the architect holds the owner contract, picks us, and our fee and liability are conventional. In IPD, KOR would **co-sign with the owner and the builder**, put its profit at risk on the team’s collective result, and join before design starts. Section 3 has the full comparison. [V]
3. **Alberta is one of Canada’s two IPD centres of gravity — but it’s a small, repeat-owner club, not a wave.** Confirmed owners: Edmonton Public Schools (the flagship program), Red Deer Catholic, City of Edmonton, Strathcona County, EPCOR, Red Deer Polytechnic, plus private one-offs. **There is no IPD in Alberta health capital and no Alberta Infrastructure IPD framework** (its alternative-delivery play is P3). The structural seats belong overwhelmingly to **RJC** (at least five corroborated projects, seven on its own roster, with named regional IPD leads), with single projects held by Entuitive, Eng-Spire, and Fast+Epp. [V]
4. **The precedent that matters: a Vancouver structural firm has already won an Alberta IPD seat** — Fast+Epp held it on the Mosaic Centre (Edmonton, Alberta’s first IPD). Entry is documented and relationship-shaped: the owner picks the contractor and architect first, and that core hand-picks the consultants on collaborative track record and culture fit — **prior IPD experience is scored, never mandatory, and training happens after selection**. A cold RFQ from an unknown out-of-province firm has no precedent. [V]
5. **In BC, the ramification is a fork.** True IPD is rare (~3–5 projects ever) and lives in **municipal work** — where owners procure the **structural engineer directly** (Penticton posted a standalone “Structural Consultant: IPD” RFP in 2026). The big BC collaborative wave is the **health-capital Alliance model** — IPD’s sibling, now the default for hospital megaprojects — where **engineers do not sign the alliance agreement** and the seat is reached through the contractor/architect pursuit team, exactly like our Prime Consultant playbook. [V]
6. **The money and risk, honestly:** every published Canadian IPD study we found paid the team full profit (Mosaic finished 12% under market), but no structural-engineer-specific outcome is published anywhere; standard professional-liability insurance has named IPD gaps that need a broker’s work before any signature; and IPD disputes still reach courtrooms despite the no-suit clause. [V]

2. What IPD actually is — at the contract level [V unless noted]

- **The document:** CCDC 30 — a single poly-party contract (real Canadian teams have had 24+ signatories). Smaller consultants can alternatively join via a flow-through “joining agreement” under a prime party. The 2025 revision is already in use (Penticton’s 2026 fire hall is CCDC 30-2025).
- **The money:** audited, open-book **burdened costs are reimbursed** regardless of outcome; **profit is fixed as a lump sum and pooled**. Underrun: full profit plus a share of savings (typical published structures: an owner hurdle of ~2%, then up to 80% to the team, capped at 50–100% of target profit). Overrun: the pool is consumed proportionally — down to zero. The floor (costs always reimbursed) is the market norm but **negotiated, not automatic**.
- **The liability deal:** parties waive claims against each other except wilful default, and defend third-party claims jointly. This is the clause that makes conventional E&O insurance imperfect for IPD (Section 7).
- **The process:** a paid **validation phase** first — the integrated team tests whether scope fits budget and can honestly kill the project there. Then design with **target value design** (designing to the cost, continuously estimated with the trades in the room), big-room/co-location sessions, Last Planner scheduling, and heavy BIM. For the structural engineer this front-loads effort: the fabricator is commenting on your framing scheme while it’s still a sketch.
- **What it is not:** “integrated” or “collaborative” in a press release does not mean IPD. Design-build, construction management, alliances, and progressive design-build are all different contracts with different seats for the structural engineer (Section 3). Several famous “IPD” examples failed verification — see Sections 4 and 6.

3. How IPD compares with the seat KOR sits in today [V unless noted; alliance sub-tier terms are [I]]

	Prime Consultant (KOR today)	Design-Build	IPD (CCDC 30)	BC Health Alliance
KOR's contract is with	The architect (who holds the owner contract)	The design-builder (contractor)	Everyone — one multi-party contract (or joining agreement under a prime)	Not signed by engineers — KOR would subcontract to a signatory (architect or contractor)
Who picks the SE	The architect	The contractor	The owner-selected contractor+architect core, jointly (sometimes the owner directly — BC municipal)	The GC/architect assembling the pursuit team, pre-RFQ
When KOR joins	After the architect wins	At pursuit or after award	Before validation — before design exists	At RFQ team formation
Fee & risk	Conventional fee; downside = scope creep	Conventional fee; flow-down liability risk	Costs reimbursed; entire profit at risk on team performance	Signatories: costs + profit-at-risk with 50/50 pain/gain to a profit-zero stop-loss; sub-tier consultants: typically conventional [I — sub-tier terms not published]
Liability	Conventional professional liability	Conventional + flow-down	Mutual waiver except wilful default; insurance needs bespoke work	No-blame among signatories; sub-tier conventional [I]
How KOR wins the seat	Architect relationships	Contractor precon relationships	Sponsor relationship with the contractor/architect core + culture-fit interview	Architect/GC pursuit-team relationships (the existing playbook)

The practical translation: **the entry skill KOR already has (being the firm architects and contractors want on their team) is the same skill IPD selection tests** — what changes is the contract you sign after you're picked, and the commercial position it puts you in. [V]

4. Alberta — the real landscape [V unless noted]

The owner club (2015–2026): Edmonton Public School Board (the flagship — a bundled multi-school IPD program), Red Deer Catholic (Alberta's first publicly-funded IPD, 2017), City of Edmonton (the EXPO Centre rehab was its first IPD; the Ambleside Operations Centre, completing fall 2026, is its third per the industry association — the second isn't publicly identified), Strathcona County, EPCOR (utility/civil), Red Deer Polytechnic, and the private Mosaic Centre. **Calgary's school boards run conventional tendering; AHS/Covenant use CM/DB/P3; Alberta Infrastructure has no IPD framework** — its alternative-delivery strategy is P3 (e.g., the Concert-Bird six-school DBFM bundle, which is not IPD). **Key projects and their teams:**

Project	Owner	Contractor	Architect	Structural
Mosaic Centre, Edmonton (Alberta's first IPD, 2015)	Private	Chandos	Manasc Isaac	Fast+Epp (Vancouver)
Escuela Mill Creek + 5 more EPSB schools	EPSB	Delnor/Chandos	ACI + Number TEN	RJC
Thelma Chalifoux + Soraya Hafez schools (bundled)	EPSB	Delnor	ACI + Number TEN	RJC
St. Joseph High School, Red Deer (first public IPD, 2017)	Red Deer Catholic	Chandos	Group2	—
St. Lorenzo Ruiz School, Red Deer	Red Deer Catholic	Clark Builders	Group2	RJC

Project	Owner	Contractor	Architect	Structural
Red Deer Polytechnic Residence (mass timber)	RDP	Clark Builders	Reimagine	RJC
Drayton Valley Aquatic Centre	Town	Chandos	Group2	RJC
Garth Worthington School	EPSB	Chandos	Group2	Entuitive
Edmonton EXPO Centre rehab (~\$100M, City's first IPD)	City of Edmonton	Delnor	ACI	Eng-Spire
EPCOR Primary Effluent Channel (civil)	EPCOR	Graham	n/a	—
King's University Science Centre (\$20M, opening fall 2026)	King's University	Delnor	Group2	—
Strathcona Fieldhouse (\$65M, building 2026–28)	Strathcona County	Chandos-Bird JV	Group2	never publicly named
Strathcona County Fire Station 7 — IPD-team RFP posted Oct 2025 (posting AB-2025-05615; required an architect, GC, structural consultant and structural trade on a cost-plus-profit-at-risk IPD agreement)	Strathcona County	<i>award to watch</i>	—	—

The incumbency: RJC is the structural incumbent by a wide margin (its own published Alberta IPD roster lists seven projects; at least five are independently corroborated), with named regional IPD leads (Pat Elischer, Jeff Rabinovitch, Kumbo Mwanan'gonze). Entuitive holds one (Garth Worthington), **Eng-Spire** holds one (the EXPO Centre — confirmed on its own project page and the Delnor/ACI team pages), and Fast+Epp held the first (Mosaic). Four firms total — a wider field than “RJC owns it,” and proof the seat is winnable project-by-project.

Growth verdict, honestly: steady inside the same club since ~2015, **no new owner categories since ~2021**. The often-quoted “60 Canadian IPD projects” figure dates from 2022. If someone is asking KOR about IPD in Alberta, the trigger is most likely inside this club — worth asking them which project or owner prompted it.

5. The Alberta player map and the way in [V unless noted]

- **Contractors:** **Chandos** (Edmonton-founded; the most Alberta IPD delivered; Jen Hancock, VP Collaborative Construction, is the field's most visible voice), **Delnor** (EPSB schools, EXPO Centre, King's — and was itself a first-time IPD contractor once, proof the club admits newcomers), **Clark Builders**, **Graham** (civil/utility IPD via EPCOR; buildings language is alliance/PDB), **Bird** (in Alberta via the Chandos-Bird JV; IPD-active in BC/ON).
- **Architects:** **ACI** (Jason McConaghie — principal and IPDA board member; the EPSB/EXPO thread), **Group2** (Craig Webber — claims 17 IPD projects, its own count [UNVERIFIED beyond the six named in Section 4]; the Red Deer/Strathcona/King's thread), **Reimagine** (ex-Manasc Isaac; Mosaic, RDP), **Number TEN**. **DIALOG: an IPDA member but zero delivered Alberta IPD found** — the forming DIALOG relationship is not an IPD door today (though their Edmonton studio is worth asking about unannounced pursuits; note DIALOG does appear in BC alliance pursuit pairings with EllisDon — Section 6).
- **The room where this community actually meets:** the **Integrated Project Delivery Alliance (IPDA)** — Canadian, Alberta-heavy board (WSP Structures Alberta's Patrick Taylor is Treasurer; members include EPSB, the Cities of Edmonton and Calgary, U of A, EPCOR, Strathcona County, RJC, Stantec, DIALOG, Bird, PCL, Graham — **KOR is not on the list**), plus free monthly IPD “Lean Coffee” meetups in Edmonton and Calgary. **IPDA's 2026 national conference is in Calgary — Fairmont Palliser, November 3–4, 2026** (registration pricing not yet posted on the conference site) — the highest-value room in the country for this, and it is in Alberta this cycle.
- **The call list** — every address below passed a live mailbox deliverability check on 2026-07-03 (the one exception is labeled):

Person	Role / why them	Email
Jason McConaghie	Principal, ACI + IPDA board — the strongest single door into Edmonton IPD	jmcconaghie@aci-arch.com

Person	Role / why them	Email
Craig Webber	Principal, Group2 — Past President of the IPDA ; the most experienced IPD architect in Alberta	craig.webber@group2.ca
Jen Hancock	VP Collaborative Construction, Chandos — the field's most visible practice leader	jhancock@chandos.com
Lindsay Worton	Chandos; IPDA Education Co-Chair	lworton@chandos.com
Padraig McCarthy	VP & District Manager Calgary, Chandos — natural pre-contact before the November conference	pmccarthy@chandos.com
D'Arcy Newberry	SVP Strategic Operations, Chandos	dnewberry@chandos.com
Glenn Cyrankiewicz	CEO & Principal, Delnor — the contractor that was itself once a first-time IPD entrant	glennnc@delnor.ca
Paul Verhesen	President, Clark Builders	paul.verhesen@clarkbuilders.com
Avel Espiritu	Host, Edmonton IPD Lean Coffee (free monthly meetup)	avel@red-5.ca (<i>published by IPDA; domain accepts all mail so the check is inconclusive</i>)

Competitor contacts — RJC's three regional IPD leads — are on file in KOR's BD database with the same treatment; they are listed there for market awareness, not outreach.

- **How a first-timer gets in (documented cases):** owners mandate IPD → the contractor/architect core cascade-selects consultants → selection interviews test collaborative behaviour and culture fit, not IPD résumé; **training comes after selection**. One Alberta RFP (Strathcona Fire Station 7) required the structural engineer named on the team at submission — meaning the relationship must exist *before* the posting. The realistic KOR path: **APEGA Permit to Practice first** (hard prerequisite, already on KOR's Alberta list) → IPDA membership + Edmonton Lean Coffee presence → conventional work or genuine relationships with Chandos/Delnor/Clark and ACI/Group2 → be the seismic/mass-timber-capable option RJC isn't when the next team forms.

6. BC — what IPD means at home [V unless noted]

- **True IPD in BC is rare: roughly 3–5 projects ever.** Kamloops Canada Games Aquatic Centre (2019 — “BC's first IPD”; WSP co-signed as an engineer party), 1st & Clark Vancouver (BC Housing/City/VCH — reported as BC's first CCDC 30, lower confidence), Burnaby Fire Halls #4 and #8 (**RJC structural**), and Penticton's fire hall (**CCDC 30-2025, signed June 2026** — Chandos again). Famous “BC IPD” claims that failed verification: UBC Brock Commons (construction management), Cowichan Hospital (Alliance, not IPD).
- **The important BC fork for a structural engineer:** in the **municipal IPD lane, owners procure the SE directly** — Penticton posted a standalone “Structural Consultant: IPD” RFP, and Kamloops co-evaluated engineer proposals at the owner table. That is a door KOR can walk through without a sponsor. In the **health-capital Alliance lane** (Cowichan, Richmond, Burnaby — now the Province's default for hospital megaprojects), the alliance agreement is bespoke (Australian-inspired, not CCDC 30), signatories stop at owner/contractor/architect, and **engineers do not sign** — the structural seat is reached through the GC/architect pursuit team before the RFQ, which is exactly the Prime-Consultant-shaped path in KOR's existing playbook. A real 2024 alliance RFQ (Richmond Hospital) scored prior collaborative experience at only 20/100 — and key individuals' résumés at 50/100. **No structural firm has been confirmed as a direct BC alliance signatory** (architects have been).
- **Trajectory:** growing, under the “Alliance” name — Infrastructure BC's own published alliance project count rose across its 2025 publications to roughly nine, spanning hospitals and highways [I — count assembled from IBC publications; the direction is solid, the exact tally less so], and it states it will continue using the model. Tempered by Budget 2026 capital re-pacing: Burnaby Hospital Phase 2 paused, the Fraser River Tunnel collaborative contract terminated. Next likely collaborative owners: VCH (Richmond Phases 2–3, construction 2026–29), Northern Health (UHNBC), municipal fire halls (Vancouver Firehalls 2 and 9 — rumoured, UNVERIFIED), BC Housing. No standing contractor–architect alliances exist in BC, but repeat pursuit pairings are visible: **EllisDon+DIALOG**, EllisDon+Parkin/ZGF, and Chandos+Johnston Davidson.
- **Regulatory reality:** EGBC has published nothing on IPD, alliances, or CCDC 30 (verified absence) — the only firm-level constant is the mandatory individual secondary-liability program (~\$250K). There is no BC-specific legal commentary on the IPD insurance question at all; the closest is a Vancouver construction lawyer's 2013 observation that alliance risks can be “difficult to insure.” KOR would be working from first principles with its broker — like everyone else.

7. The money and the risk — what KOR would actually sign up for [V unless noted]

- **Downside is capped but real:** costs reimbursed, profit at risk. On an overrun — anyone's overrun, fault-irrelevant — the shared profit pool drains toward zero. You can do excellent structural work and still earn nothing above cost because a trade partner blew its budget. That is the deal; it is also why teams pick partners so carefully.
- **The published record is good:** every Canadian IPD study found paid the team its full profit; Mosaic Centre finished 12% under comparable market cost. **No published data isolates a structural engineer's profit outcome on any Canadian IPD project** — the claim “consultants do well in IPD” rests on team-level results and testimonials. [V for studies; the gap is the point]
- **Insurance needs real work before any signature:** standard E&O has named IPD gaps (insured-vs-insured exclusions when parties share one contract; contractual-liability exclusions against the waiver regime; no cover for rectifying your own work). The documented fixes are project-specific professional liability policies or written carrier endorsements. An Aon executive has publicly flagged collaborative contracting “without the right insurance design” as an emerging industry risk. This is a broker conversation, not a form to sign.
- **“Aligned incentives” is not “dispute-proof”:** an IPD project reached the NWT Supreme Court in 2025 (*Onec Construction v. NWT Energy*), and a Saskatchewan IPD dispute went through arbitration and appeal. Rare, but the no-suit clause has edges.

8. Recommended actions (dated)

1. **Now:** ask the person who raised IPD **which project or owner prompted the question** — the Alberta club is small enough that the trigger is probably identifiable (the live items: Edmonton Fire Station 7 award, Strathcona Fieldhouse, King's University, EPSB's next bundle).
2. **Now (cheap):** buy CCDC 30 and its Schedule A and have a principal read them — every mechanic in this document should be verified against the actual text before KOR sits in any IPD interview. (~\$100 from CCDC.)
3. **July–August:** progress the **APEGA Permit to Practice** — it gates everything in Alberta, IPD included.
4. **September:** join **IPDA** and start showing up at the **Edmonton Lean Coffee** (free, monthly). Both RJC and DIALOG are already members; KOR's absence is visible.
5. **By early fall: register for the IPDA national conference — Calgary, Fairmont Palliser, November 3–4, 2026** (pricing not yet posted — watch the conference page). One trip puts KOR in front of the entire Canadian IPD community, in Alberta, this cycle.
6. **Before any pursuit:** broker conversation on E&O vs project-specific cover for multi-party contracts (Section 7) — and price it into any IPD fee.
7. **Watch (Alberta):** Strathcona County's Fire Station 7 IPD award (which structural engineer got the seat?); the Strathcona Fieldhouse SE identity; EPSB's next school bundle.
8. **Watch (BC):** municipal IPD postings — the Penticton precedent means **direct structural-engineer IPD RFPs now exist in BC**; and keep the health-alliance path running through architect relationships per the existing playbook (Richmond Phases 2–3 and UHNBC are the live ones).

9. What we could not verify (open items)

The structural engineer on Strathcona Fieldhouse (county communications never itemize engineering disciplines — the award staff report on the county's meeting portal would name it; a browser check of Q1–Q2 2024 agendas is the concrete next step); the Fire Station 7 award (unannounced as of 2026-07-03; the county's Budget 2026 release moved the station's opening from 2028 to mid-2029); CCDC 30's actual contract text (paywalled — all mechanics herein rest on 2+ corroborating secondary sources each; hence action 2); any SE-specific profit outcome on a Canadian IPD project (none published); the EPCOR Biogas IPD RFP (single-source lead); Vancouver Firehalls 2 & 9 as IPD (rumour); DIALOG's unannounced pursuits; the exact contract path of sub-tier consultants on BC alliance hospitals (e.g., the structural engineer's terms on Cowichan sit below the published signing tier); three Alberta school projects attributed to the IPD program on inference only (Alex Janvier, East Chappelle, Morrin).

Appendix — source list (primary)

ccdc.org (CCDC 30) · ipda.ca (members, case studies, IPD guide, 2026 conference) · leanipd.com (Canadian IPD school studies) · chandos.com · delnor.ca · clarkbuilders.com · grahambuilds.com · bird.ca · group2.ca · aci-arch.com · numberten.com · rjc.ca (Alberta IPD roster; Red Deer Polytechnic) · fastepp.com (Mosaic) · primedmosaiccentre.com · strathcona.ca (Fieldhouse award, \$65M) · majorprojects.alberta.ca · alberta.ca (School Capital Manual; alternative capital financing) · kingsu.ca (Science Centre IPD) · stok.com (EXPO Centre) · watercanada.net (EPCOR) · buildingtransformations.org (Dentons/KMB IPD article; Calgary Cancer Centre) · infrastructurebc.com (alliance program, project counts) · bchousing.org (1st & Clark) · city of Kamloops/Penticton/Burnaby procurement records · rdnewsnow.com · sabmagazine.com · egbc.ca (verified absence of IPD guidance; secondary-liability program) · blg.com + osler.com + singleton.com + reminetwork.com (Hirst) + glaholt.com (CCDC 30 legal commentary; liability/insurance) · CanLII (*Onec v. NWT Energy*, 2025 NWTSC 56) · KOR playbook (BC health alliance mechanics, Channel 5). *Method: four*

independent research streams (the Alberta landscape; contract mechanics; the player map; BC status), each checked against primary sources claim by claim, followed by an independent fact-check of the finished document. Claims that failed checking were removed rather than repeated — several projects commonly described as IPD are actually other delivery models (Calgary Fire Station #18, UBC Brock Commons, Cowichan Hospital), and the text notes each. Where the streams disagreed, the difference was resolved from the underlying sources (Graham's confirmed IPD is civil work; Bird's is via the Chandos-Bird joint venture; RJC's count is five corroborated of seven self-reported). A same-day follow-up check of municipal records identified the EXPO Centre structural engineer (Eng-Spire) and confirmed the Fire Station 7 award remained unannounced, with the station's opening moved to mid-2029. Prepared 2026-07-03.